

Use CoffeeScript To Write Your JavaScript



JavaScript has become the lingua franca of the Web and has gained a lot of popularity in recent years. Many frameworks and technologies have been inspired by JavaScript, and it now powers most websites. CoffeeScript helps you to produce JavaScript, without actually writing too much code.

Even though JavaScript is a powerful language, it has a few drawbacks such as the structural programming style. JavaScript has been populated with braces and semicolons in its source script, which produces a lot of coding for simple tasks.

CoffeeScript, on the other hand, is a language that compiles into JavaScript. The underlying idea for CoffeeScript is '*JUST JavaScript!*'. CoffeeScript enables you to produce the JavaScript without writing as much code as you have done previously with JavaScript.

The history of CoffeeScript

CoffeeScript originated on December 13, 2009. Jeremy Ashkenas released CoffeeScript 0.1.0 with documentation and a compiler written in Ruby.

On February 21, 2010, CoffeeScript 0.5.0 was released.

This time the compiler was replaced by the compiler written in CoffeeScript itself.

February 25, 2013, saw CoffeeScript 1.5.0, which was a significant release supporting 'Literate Programming'.

Dropbox announced on September 13, 2012, that its browser side codebase replaced JavaScript with CoffeeScript.

Installing CoffeeScript

To install CoffeeScript on your Linux machine, first install *npm* (node package manager) on your machine and run the following command in a terminal:

```
sudo apt-get install npm
```

Once you are done with the installation of *npm*, it's time to install CoffeeScript.